

Chapter 2

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Career Planning Worksheet

PART 1: JOB VALUES INVENTORY WORKSHEET

This exercise helps you identify which job qualities you value most. Remember, these may change over time depending on your life situation. Once you begin exploring job possibilities, focus only on jobs that meet your highest ranked values.

Directions: Rank the items below from 1 to 12, with 1 being most important and 12 the least important.

Job Value	Rank (1-12)
Good salary	
Good benefits (insurance, retirement, etc.)	
Job security	
Work hours that meet your needs	
Satisfactory location	
Compatible coworkers, supervisors, customers	
Opportunity to learn and develop skills	
Challenging and satisfying work	
Good working conditions / environment	
Like / believe in what the organization does	

Chance for promotion / advancement	
Prestige and respect	

Job Value

Rank (1-12)

Good salary

Good benefits (insurance, retirement, etc.)

Job security

Work hours that meet your needs

Satisfactory location

Compatible coworkers, supervisors, customers

Opportunity to learn and develop skills

Challenging and satisfying work

Good working conditions / environment

Like / believe in what the organization does

Chance for promotion / advancement

Prestige and respect

Reflection Question: If you are employed or have worked before, are your job values different today than when you first started working?

Next step to complete your Career and Education Planning Worksheet: In the section marked "Self-Exploration," fill in the top three job and work values that you identified above.

PART 2: SKILLS IDENTIFICATION WORKSHEET

Directions:

- Read over the list of skills below. Put a check mark next to each skill that you have.
- For each skill that you checked, circle the ones that you think are your strongest.

Communication Skills

Skill	Check if you have this skill
Reading and following directions	
Putting things in alphabetical order	
Comparing or cross-checking two lists	
Filling out forms	
Writing letters and memos correctly	

Reading and understanding policies and memos	
Writing reports	
Speaking to people I don't know	
Speaking English and another Language	
Taking notes while someone speaks	
Finding information (phonebook, dictionary, library, etc.)	
Using a map	
Reading bus, train, and plane schedules	
Explaining things to other people	
Knowing when to ask for help or more explanation	
Total # of Communication Skills	

Skill

Check if you have this skill

Reading and following directions

Putting things in alphabetical order

Comparing or cross-checking two lists

Filling out forms

Writing letters and memos correctly

Reading and understanding policies and memos

Writing reports

Speaking to people I don't know

Speaking English and another Language

Taking notes while someone speaks

Finding information (phonebook, dictionary, library, etc.)

Using a map

Reading bus, train, and plane schedules

Explaining things to other people

Knowing when to ask for help or more explanation

Total # of Communication Skills

Number Skills

Skill	Check if you have this skill
Doing arithmetic correctly	
Using percentages and decimals	
Using a calculator	
Rounding off numbers	
Typing/keyboarding	
Calculating hours worked, money owed, etc.	
Estimating costs and/or time needed to complete a job	
Using a database program on a computer	
Total # of Number Skills	

Skill

Check if you have this skill

Doing arithmetic correctly

Using percentages and decimals

Using a calculator

Rounding off numbers

Typing/keyboarding

Calculating hours worked, money owed, etc.

Estimating costs and/or time needed to complete a job

Using a database program on a computer

Total # of Number Skills

Technical Skills

Skill	Check if you have this skill
Making, fixing, and repairing things	

Operating machinery	
Installing things	
Building things	
Gardening, landscaping, or farming	
Total # of Technical Skills	

Skill

Check if you have this skill

Making, fixing, and repairing things

Operating machinery

Installing things

Building things

Gardening, landscaping, or farming

Total # of Technical Skills

Business Skills

Skill	Check if you have this skill
Operating a computer	
Using a business telephone	
Filing, sorting, and classifying information	
Balancing checkbooks	
Working with budgets	
Setting up and closing out a cash register	
Total # of Business Skills	

Skill

Check if you have this skill

Operating a computer

Using a business telephone

Filing, sorting, and classifying information

Balancing checkbooks

Working with budgets

Setting up and closing out a cash register

Total # of Business Skills

Management and Self-Management Skills

Skill	Check if you have this skill
Being patient with others	
Keeping a cheerful attitude	
Getting interested/excited about the task at hand	
Offering to help when needed	
Knowing how to take direction	
Motivating myself to do what needs to get done	
Helping motivate others to get the job done	
Prioritizing tasks so that the larger goal is met on time	
Following the rules	
Presenting a neat and professional image	
Checking my own work	
Working hard without complaining	
Using courtesy when dealing with others	
Seeking help when needed	
Being eager to learn	
Speaking up for myself	

Solving problems in a cooperative way	
Total # of Management and Self-Management Skills	

Skill

Check if you have this skill

Being patient with others

Keeping a cheerful attitude

Getting interested/excited about the task at hand

Offering to help when needed

Knowing how to take direction

Motivating myself to do what needs to get done

Helping motivate others to get the job done

Prioritizing tasks so that the larger goal is met on time

Following the rules

Presenting a neat and professional image

Checking my own work

Working hard without complaining

Using courtesy when dealing with others

Seeking help when needed

Being eager to learn

Speaking up for myself

Solving problems in a cooperative way

Total # of Management and Self-Management Skills

Creative/Artistic Skills

Skill	Check if you have this skill
Artistic	
Drawing	
Expressing	
Performing	
Presenting artistic ideas	
Dancing, body movement	

Visualizing shapes	
Designing	
Model making	
Making handicrafts	
Writing poetry	
Illustrating, sketching	
Doing photography	
Mechanical drawing	
Total # of Creative/Artistic Skills	

Skill

Check if you have this skill

Artistic

Drawing

Expressing

Performing

Presenting artistic ideas

Dancing, body movement

Visualizing shapes

Designing

Model making

Making handicrafts

Writing poetry

Illustrating, sketching

Doing photography

Mechanical drawing

Total # of Creative/Artistic Skills

People Skills

Skill	Check if you have this skill
-------	------------------------------

Caring for children responsibly	
Caring for the sick and elderly	
Showing warmth and caring	
Calming people down	
Helping people complete a task	
Teaching someone how to do something	
Knowing how to get along with different people/personalities	
Leading groups or activities	
Total # of People Skills	

Skill

Check if you have this skill

Caring for children responsibly

Caring for the sick and elderly

Showing warmth and caring

Calming people down

Helping people complete a task

Teaching someone how to do something

Knowing how to get along with different people/personalities

Leading groups or activities

Total # of People Skills

Reflection Questions:

Do you have skills in more than one category? _____

In which category do you have the most skills? _____

Of the skills you circled as your strongest, what do you think are your top three skills?

-
-
-

Are there some skills that you would like to have, but don't have right now? List them here.

What education and/or training might you need to develop those skills?

Next step to complete your Career and Education Planning Worksheet: In the section marked "Self-

Exploration," fill in your top three skills which you listed above.

PART 3: THINGS I HAVE DONE WORKSHEET

Directions:

- Read over the list of items in the columns below. Put a check mark beside each thing you have done.
- Count up all the check marks in each column. Write the total at the bottom of each column.
- Now, go back and circle the items in each column that you like the most.

Working With People

Activity	Check if you have done this
Take care of a sick relative	
Give medicine to a child	
Care for child who is disabled	
Help at a school event	
Make phone calls	
Visit friends or family in nursing homes	
Visit new places	
Take care of my children or other people's children	
Teach or coach a sport	
Organize parties for family or friends	
Teach at my place of worship	
Help children with their homework	
Participate in events in my community	
Volunteer at a library	
Work with other parents in the schools	

Go on field trips for teens and help out	
Play music or dance for others	
Other _____	
Total # of check marks	

Activity

Check if you have done this

Take care of a sick relative

Give medicine to a child

Care for child who is disabled

Help at a school event

Make phone calls

Visit friends or family in nursing homes

Visit new places

Take care of my children or other people's children

Teach or coach a sport

Organize parties for family or friends

Teach at my place of worship

Help children with their homework

Participate in events in my community

Volunteer at a library

Work with other parents in the schools

Go on field trips for teens and help out

Play music or dance for others

Other _____

Total # of check marks

Working With Data

Activity	Check if you have done this
Write checks and balance a checkbook	
Do a budget for my family	
Keep financial records for a club or group	

Handle the finances for a small business	
Read a map	
Follow directions	
Read a flyer or poster	
Apply for a loan or credit	
Fill out forms and applications	
Make travel arrangements	
File papers	
Enter data on a computer	
Select and price items to be purchased by a group	
Maintain sales records for an organization's store or sale	
Choose colors for crafts or decorating projects	
Other _____	
Total # of check marks	

Activity

Check if you have done this

Write checks and balance a checkbook

Do a budget for my family

Keep financial records for a club or group

Handle the finances for a small business

Read a map

Follow directions

Read a flyer or poster

Apply for a loan or credit

Fill out forms and applications

Make travel arrangements

File papers

Enter data on a computer

Select and price items to be purchased by a group

Maintain sales records for an organization's store or sale

Choose colors for crafts or decorating projects

Other _____

Total # of check marks

Working With Things

Activity	Check if you have done this
Take care of plants, or a garden or farm	
Cook meals	
Do housecleaning at home	
Arrange flowers	
Care for animals	
Type, file, or do office work for an organization	
Use a computer	
Take photographs	
Operate stereo equipment	
Build furniture	
Repair equipment or appliances	
Operate equipment such as a lawnmower, saw, or forklift	
Use tools	
Drive a bus, van, or taxi	
Prepare meals for large groups	

Build things	
Cut down trees	
Give haircuts or do hair styling	
Take care of cars	
Other _____	
Total # of check marks	

Activity

Check if you have done this

Take care of plants, or a garden or farm

Cook meals

Do housecleaning at home

Arrange flowers

Care for animals

Type, file, or do office work for an organization

Use a computer

Take photographs

Operate stereo equipment

Build furniture

Repair equipment or appliances

Operate equipment such as a lawnmower, saw, or forklift

Use tools

Drive a bus, van, or taxi

Prepare meals for large groups

Build things

Cut down trees

Give haircuts or do hair styling

Take care of cars

Other _____

Total # of check marks

Reflection Questions:

Which column has the most check marks? _____

Which column has the most circled items? _____

Note whether the column with the most circled items differs from the column with the most check marks. If the things you like to do are different from the things you have done, you may want to think about how to gain the skills or education to do more of the things that you like to do.

Next step to complete your Career and Education Planning Worksheet: In the section marked "Self-Exploration," put a check mark beside the area in which you have the most experience based on your answer above.

CAREER AND EDUCATION PLANNING SUMMARY

Self-Exploration Summary:

Category	Your Response
My top three job and work values:	
• 1.	
• 2.	
• 3.	
My top three skills:	
• 1.	
• 2.	
• 3.	
Area with most experience (check one):	
Working with People	
Working with Data	
Working with Things	

Category

Your Response

My top three job and work values:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

My top three skills:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Area with most experience (check one):

Working with People

Working with Data

Working with Things